Class Notes - 9 October 2026

Topics today: Nobel Prizes (Literature 2026 + others) | Snow Leopard Safari (Ladakh) | Asiatic Lion, Maldhari tribe & Wardha WLS | Living Planet Report 2026 | Rapid-fire news. *Air Force Day was to be covered today (announced the day before).*

Start of class

- **9 October** = **death anniversary** of **Ratan Tata** (class warm-up question; students answered correctly).
- **Thought of the day:** there is no bad time to start a good task - you only have to decide when to begin. Do not wait for God to announce an auspicious day; you work first, then help follows.
- **Announcements:** Target batch classes start from **Monday**; join the Crash Course if not yet joined. Class PDF is shared on **Telegram**. Stay till the end of class (a notice is given at the end). The **Economic Reforms** topic will be taught **tomorrow**. Class is a recorded class.
- **Study advice for CGL:** revise the **'Most Important 100 Current Affairs of CGL'** PPT/lecture (end of September). Revise Jan-Sept current affairs from a magazine; the SSC textbook-based merged classes (4 PM) also cover it. 'Current affairs is current affairs - there is no separate version.'

TOPIC 1 - Nobel Prizes (Literature 2026 announced; 2025 and other fields)

Six categories of Nobel Prize in total. Physics, Medicine, Chemistry and Literature have been announced so far. Literature can be asked at any time in the exam.

Field	Year	Winner(s) as given in class	Memory trick / note
Literature	**2026**	**Anne (Annie) Carson** - belongs to **Canada** (Carson + Canada)	Awarded for a large body of work; introduced a **new form of contemporary literature**.
Literature	2025	**Laszlo** (first name as stated in class)	Name is important.
Medicine	2026	3 people: **Peter Hegemann, Georg Nagel, Karl Deisseroth**	Earlier trick 'MDH' changed to **'NDH'** (Nagel, Deisseroth, Hegemann).
Physics	2026	1 person: **Francis Halzen**	**PF** (Provident Fund) = **P**hysics - **F**rancis.
Chemistry	2026	2 people: **'Henry' and 'Kanso'** (audio unclear in recording)	Trick **CSK**: C = Chemistry, S = 'Soi', K = 'Kagan' (as spoken).

Anne Carson - key details:

- Won the 2026 Nobel Prize in **Literature**; she is from **Canada**. Surname: **Carson**.
- Reason: many books/works; major contribution to literature; introduced a **new form in contemporary literature**.
- Important books: **'Nox'** and **'Autobiography of Red'** (remember both). Another important book: **'Float'** - released in **2016** (old books are also being asked in papers now).
- **India link:** India's only Literature Nobel - **1913**, book **'Gitanjali'**, by **Rabindranath Tagore**.

QUICK REVISION - Nobel

- 6 categories | Literature 2026: Anne Carson (Canada) - Nox, Autobiography of Red, Float (2016) | Literature 2025: Laszlo
- Medicine 2026 = 3 (Hegemann, Nagel, Deisseroth) -> 'NDH' | Physics 2026 = Francis Halzen (PF) | Chemistry 2026 = 2 persons -> 'CSK'
- India: Tagore, 1913, Gitanjali.

TOPIC 2 - Rapid-fire questions asked at the start (answers from class)

Question	Answer / details
Two states with the **Ballari-Gutala** (Gooty) railway zone/project	**Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh**
UNESCO World Heritage Site recently added - **Sarnath**	Site number **45** (as given); located in **Varanasi**
When is **Global Tiger Day** celebrated?	**29 July** (stated in class)
Starlink (Elon Musk) in India	Musk wants to enter India; many rules/conditions have been specified in writing; the problem is he is still not able to launch in India. Not a new issue.

Class Notes - 9 October 2026 (continued)

TOPIC 3 - India's First High-Altitude Snow Leopard Safari (Ladakh)

Question: In which Union Territory has India's first high-altitude Snow Leopard Safari been set up? **Answer: Ladakh.**

What is a safari? (explained with an example)

- A place where animals are kept in the wild and you see them **from a distance** from a provided vehicle, with **guards** who regulate wildlife; the vehicle tours the whole area and returns. It is also used for **tourism**. You watch from far - you do not put your hand in the animal's mouth!

Ladakh - facts given

- Located on the **Ladakh range**. Capital: **Leh** (as stated in class).
- **Districts: 7** - 2 earlier + 5 added later.
- Lieutenant Governor (**Upraajyapal**): **Vinay Saxena** (as stated in class).
- **Highest national park in India: Hemis National Park** - in **Ladakh**.

Where is the safari? (merger of two sanctuaries)

- Built by merging two areas: **Changthang Wildlife Sanctuary** and **Karakoram Wildlife Sanctuary** (the spelling 'Thangtang' in the recording = Changthang).
- Launched as the **first high-altitude (very high elevation) Snow Leopard Safari in India** - you can see the snow leopard here, but only from a distance.
- Purpose: **to boost tourism**.

Snow Leopard - key facts

- **Hindi name: Him Tendua.** Also called **'Ghost of the Himalayas'** - it stays hidden and suddenly appears.
- In India, **maximum snow leopards are found in Ladakh**. **Total: 718** snow leopards in India.
- **IUCN status: Vulnerable.**
- Also placed under the **International Big Cat Alliance**, which includes **7 species** in total - the snow leopard is one of them.
- **Leopard City of India: Bengaluru** (where a protest was held the previous day).
- **Question asked:** snow leopard has recently been declared the **National Animal** of which country? (Students guessed Kyrgyzstan / Afghanistan / Turkey; **the final answer was not clearly stated in the recording - please verify.**)
- **Another safari:** a safari is also being built in **Uttar Pradesh** - at **Kukrail Nala, Lucknow** (Lucknow was flooded at the time).

QUICK REVISION - Snow Leopard Safari

- UT: **Ladakh** | Capital Leh | 7 districts (2 + 5) | LG: Vinay Saxena | Highest NP: **Hemis**
- Safari area = **Changthang WLS + Karakoram WLS** merged | 1st high-altitude snow leopard safari in India
- **718** snow leopards (most in Ladakh) | IUCN: **Vulnerable** | **Ghost of the Himalayas** | Big Cat Alliance: 7 species
- Leopard city: **Bengaluru** | Another safari: **Kukrail, Lucknow (UP)**

TOPIC 4 - Tiger, Passport & other quick questions

Question	Answer / details
Total **Tiger Reserves** in India now	The figure in the recording is unclear ('50-80'); it appears to be **58**. The **latest** reserve mentioned is **Madhav** in **Madhya Pradesh**. (Please verify the number.)
India's rank in the **Global (Henley) Passport Index**	**125**
Who was appointed **PM of the UK** (in place of Keir Starmer)?	Name as spoken in the recording: **'N. G. Burhan'** (audio garbled - please verify the spelling/name).
New PM of Ukraine	**Serhiy Kostiuk** (spelled 'Serhil Costiki' in the recording)

Class Notes - 9 October 2026 (continued)

TOPIC 5 - Asiatic Lion, Maldhari Tribe & Wardha Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat)

Question: Which state launched a scheme for the **Maldhari** tribe, because a **second home for Asiatic Lions** is being developed at **Wardha Wildlife Sanctuary**? **Answer: Gujarat.**

Asiatic Lion

- The lion found in Asia is the **Asiatic Lion**. In India it is found **only in Gujarat**, in **Gir National Park** - the only place in India where they live.
- **Why Gir?** It has the **Girnar Hills**, the **Hiran river** and the **Banni grasslands** - these features suit the lions.
- **IUCN category given in class: Vulnerable** (as stated by the teacher).
- A deal/project was signed in **1979** in Gujarat - the **Gir-Wardha Project**.
- Their **population is increasing**, so a **second home** is being built - at **Wardha Wildlife Sanctuary**, located **between Porbandar and Dwarka** (Gujarat).
- Developing a lion corridor / second home can be called creating a **'lion corridor'** - conservation of lions.

Maldhari Tribe - why the scheme?

- A tribe lives at the Wardha location. Conservation means people around would have to be **relocated**; humans and animals together increase **human-animal conflict**.
- **Gujarat CM: Bhupendra Patel** - state government, along with the **National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)**, decided to help them.
- Each family will receive **Rs. 15 lakh per family** so that they can shift elsewhere.
- **Who are they?** Found in **Gujarat**; **semi-nomadic** - settle where they find a place, but change location fairly often.
- Fully **dependent on livestock** - milk, ghee, wood. Hence called **'Keepers of Livestock'**.
- **Language: Kutchi** (Kachchhi).

QUICK REVISION - Asiatic Lion / Maldhari

- Asiatic lion: **Gir NP, Gujarat** (Girnar Hills, Hiran river, Banni grasslands) | IUCN: Vulnerable (as per class)
- **Gir-Wardha Project - 1979** | 2nd home: **Wardha WLS** (between **Porbandar & Dwarka**) | 'lion corridor'
- Maldhari: Gujarat | semi-nomadic | livestock keepers | **Kutchi** language | **Rs. 15 lakh/family** | CM **Bhupendra Patel** + **NTCA**

TOPIC 6 - Living Planet Report 2026 (WWF)

- **Issued by WWF** (World Wide Fund for Nature / Wildlife Fund) - **Living Planet Report 2026**.
- **Data used: 1970 to 2022**. Question: decline in wildlife population from 1970 till now? **Answer: 73%** decline.
- 'Wildlife' includes **flora and fauna** - both animals and plants.
- **WWF formed: 1961**. **Headquarters: Gland** (Switzerland) - transcript reads 'Gland'. Works **for nature**.

QUICK REVISION - Living Planet Report

- **WWF** | LPR 2026 | data 1970-2022 | **73% decline** | WWF: **1961**, HQ **Gland**

TOPIC 7 - Environment & International Rankings / Events

Question	Answer / details
Environment Performance Index (EPI) - India's rank	India is **second from the bottom**: **176 out of 177**.
3rd annual India-Australia Summit - held where?	**Melbourne**, Australia.
India's rank - Global Passport Index	**125**
Paper pattern tip	Old books and old facts are now being asked in papers; Literature Nobel can be asked anytime.

ALL MCQs from the Class - 9 October 2026

Every question asked in class, with the answer given. Items marked **[verify]** were unclear in the recording.

1. **9 October is the death anniversary of which person?**
   Ans: **Ratan Tata**
2. **Who has recently been awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature (2026)?**
   Ans: **Anne (Annie) Carson** (Canada)
3. **Two states with the Ballari-Gutala railway project?**
   Ans: **Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh**
4. **Which number UNESCO World Heritage Site is Sarnath? Where is it?**
   Ans: **45th** (as stated); **Varanasi**
5. **When is Global Tiger Day celebrated?**
   Ans: **29 July**
6. **Which UT has India's first high-altitude Snow Leopard Safari?**
   Ans: **Ladakh**
7. **Snow leopard declared National Animal of which country?**
   Ans: Answer not clear in recording **[verify]**
8. **Total tiger reserves in India (latest = Madhav, MP)?**
   Ans: **58 [verify]**
9. **India's rank in the Global Passport Index?**
   Ans: **125**
10. **Who was appointed UK PM in place of Keir Starmer?**
    Ans: 'N. G. Burhan' as spoken **[verify]**
11. **Which state launched a scheme for the Maldhari tribe (Wardha WLS, Asiatic lions)?**
    Ans: **Gujarat**
12. **Who was appointed the new PM of Ukraine?**
    Ans: **Serhiy Kostiuk** (as spoken)
13. **Where was the 3rd annual India-Australia Summit held?**
    Ans: **Melbourne**
14. **India's rank in Environment Performance Index (EPI)?**
    Ans: **176 out of 177**
15. **Who releases the Living Planet Report?**
    Ans: **WWF** (Living Planet Report 2026)
16. **Decline in wildlife population 1970 to now (LPR 2026)?**
    Ans: **73%**
17. **Year WWF was formed? Its headquarters?**
    Ans: **1961**; **Gland**
18. **Which Nobel (2026) went to Francis Halzen?**
    Ans: **Physics** (trick: PF)
19. **How many people won Nobel Medicine 2026? Names?**
    Ans: **3** - Peter Hegemann, Georg Nagel, Karl Deisseroth ('NDH')
20. **Who won the Nobel Literature in 2025?**
    Ans: **Laszlo**
21. **India's first Literature Nobel - year, book, author?**
    Ans: **1913, Gitanjali, Rabindranath Tagore**
22. **Anne Carson's important books?**
    Ans: **Nox**, **Autobiography of Red**, **Float** (2016)
23. **Capital of Ladakh? Number of districts? Highest NP?**
    Ans: **Leh**; **7** (2 + 5); **Hemis NP**
24. **Safari area formed by merging which two sanctuaries?**
    Ans: **Changthang + Karakoram WLS**
25. **Total snow leopards in India? IUCN category?**
    Ans: **718**; **Vulnerable**
26. **Nickname of snow leopard?**
    Ans: **Ghost of the Himalayas** (Him Tendua)
27. **Big Cat Alliance - how many species?**
    Ans: **7**
28. **Leopard City of India?**
    Ans: **Bengaluru**
29. **Where is another safari being built in UP?**
    Ans: **Kukrail Nala, Lucknow**
30. **Where do Asiatic Lions live in India? IUCN?**
    Ans: **Gir NP, Gujarat**; **Vulnerable** (per class)
31. **Gir-Wardha Project signed in which year?**
    Ans: **1979**
32. **Wardha WLS is located between which two places?**
    Ans: **Porbandar and Dwarka**
33. **Compensation to each Maldhari family? Gujarat CM? Language?**
    Ans: **Rs. 15 lakh**; **Bhupendra Patel**; **Kutchi**
34. **Maldhari are called 'Keepers' of what? Their nature?**
    Ans: **Livestock**; **semi-nomadic**